

PRD — Partner Category: Multi-Select (School Partners Module)

Status: Draft for review

Owner: Himanshu Kumar (Head of Product, Exxat One)

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Part: 1 of 2 — see Publish_Preference_School_Partners_PRD.docx (Part 2) for the Tiered Partners recipient-picker behavior this PRD's data-model change produces.

Related: Publish_Preference_School_Partners_PRD.docx (Part 2 — Tiered Partners picker, section 5.2, consumes this PRD's decisions), Partner_Category_MultiSelect_Mockups.zip

1. Problem

A school partner can hold exactly one Partner Category today (Bronze, Gold, Silver, Tier 1, Tier 2, or Non-Tiered Partner) — the row-level “Edit Category” panel and the individual school's About page both expose a single-select dropdown, confirmed live in QA. Himanshu asked for this to become multi-select: a school's real relationship with the site can span more than one category at once (e.g. broadly a Gold partner but specifically Tier 1 for one program), and forcing a single value loses that.

Data note: this request came directly from Himanshu rather than a logged user complaint or support-ticket pattern; there's no citation available to quantify how often a school's real relationship spans more than one category today. Flagging per the data-backed-decisions preference rather than inventing a metric to justify it.

Partner Category is also the exact taxonomy Tiered Partners (in Publish Preference) is built on. Multi-select here directly breaks an assumption Tiered Partners has relied on since before either of these PRDs existed — that each school belongs to exactly one tier. Part 2 owns the resulting recipient-picker behavior; this PRD owns the underlying data model and category-management UI, and states the resolved decisions Part 2 depends on.

2. Goals

- Convert Partner Category from single-select to multi-select at every surface that edits or displays it: the School Partners list column and filter, the row-level “Edit Category” panel, and the individual school's About page.
- Enforce a hard minimum of one category — a school can never be saved with zero categories selected. (Resolved by Himanshu.)

- Ensure any consumer of Partner Category — today, specifically Tiered Partners' recipient-qualification query — evaluates a school's current, live category set, not a value snapshotted at an earlier point. (Resolved by Himanshu: live, not snapshotted.)
- Migrate existing schools (each holding exactly one category today) non-destructively into the new multi-value structure, with zero visible change until a coordinator explicitly edits a school's categories.

3. Non-goals

- Not building the School Partners Who-Sees option or its recipient picker in Publish Preference — that is Publish_Preference_School_Partners_PRD.docx (Part 2). That picker is qualified by Program Type/Discipline, not by Partner Category, and is entirely untouched by this PRD.
- Not specifying the Tiered Partners panel's UI response to multi-category overlap (qualified-school counts, the de-duplication notice, Figure 9 in Part 2) — that UI lives inside Publish Preference's recipient picker and is owned by Part 2. This PRD states the underlying resolved behavior (live evaluation, minimum-one-category) that Part 2's UI depends on, and stops there.
- Not adding a bulk category-assignment tool. No bulk-edit capability for Partner Category exists today (confirmed in QA — the only edit surfaces are the row-level panel and the About page, both single-school); this PRD keeps that one-at-a-time editing model. Flagged as a possible follow-up in Open Questions, not resolved here.
- Not resolving OR vs. AND semantics for the list-level Category filter with certainty — see Open Questions.
- Not touching Discover & Engage, Consortium/Program Partner, or anything already out of scope in Part 2 — those non-goals stand unchanged.
- Not touching the Contracts tab's Associated Locations data. QA investigation of the individual school partner page (About/Contracts/Engagement Log/Requests/Schedules tabs) surfaced that contracts carry their own Location associations, independent of Category — a related but separate dimension, already flagged elsewhere as a possible third school-qualification axis. Out of scope here.
- Not cleaning up the two leftover XSS-test junk values found in the live Category dropdown during QA investigation (e.g. stray script-injection test strings left over from prior QA activity) — a pre-existing data hygiene issue, unrelated to this change. Flagged in Open Questions rather than fixed silently here.

3a. Permissions (assumption, not confirmed)

This PRD does not independently confirm who is permitted to edit a school's Partner Category. The working assumption is that it inherits whatever access already gates the School Partners module's row-level Edit action and About-page edit pencil today — no new role or permission

gate is introduced by moving that field from single-select to multi-select. This assumption is not verified against the current RBAC model and is carried forward as an open question (section 11) rather than asserted as a resolved decision.

4. Current state (baseline, verified in QA)

On the School Partners list page (Site Portal), the Category column renders one plain-text value per school — no color, no chip styling. The toolbar's Category filter is a single-select control.

The row-level Edit action (pencil icon) opens a narrow “Edit Category” slide-over: University Name, Alias Name, and Address are shown read-only; Partner Category is the only editable field, rendered as a single-select dropdown (Bronze, Gold, Non-Tiered Partner, Silver, Tier 1, Tier 2, plus two leftover XSS-test junk values found live in QA).

The individual school's About page (reached by clicking the school's name) shows the same Basic Information fields — Name, Alias Name, Category, Website, Associated Discipline, Address — read-only, with its own pencil icon. That pencil opens the identical “Edit Category” panel already described; it exposes no additional fields beyond the row-level edit. The About page also has Contracts, Engagement Log, Requests, and Schedules tabs; the Contracts tab shows contract-level data including Associated Locations, which is unrelated to Category (see Non-Goals).

Category is the same taxonomy Tiered Partners already uses as tier names in Publish Preference — confirmed by cross-referencing both live QA flows.

5. Proposed change

5.1 School Partners list — Category column and filter

The Category column renders one chip per assigned category instead of a single plain-text value; if a school's chips exceed the column's available width, the overflow collapses to a “+N more” indicator rather than wrapping the row taller. The Category filter in the toolbar becomes a multi-select checklist, replacing today's single-select control.

Exxat One

Bedlam Physical Therapy

Dashboard

Ask Leo

Vinay bn

School Partners

School Partners

+ Add Partner

Search

State

Category (3)

Contract Status

Program Contact Details

Discipline

Filter by Category

Multi-select

☒ Bronze
 ☒ Gold
 ☐ Silver
 ☒ Tier 1
 ☐ Tier 2
 ☐ Non-Tiered Partner

Matches ANY selected category

Apply

SCHOOL NAME	WEBSITE	ADDRESS	CATEGORY	CONTRACTS	PROGRAM CONTACT	ASSOCIATED DISCIPLINE	ACTIONS
Exxat	exxat.		Bronze Gold Tier 1	2 Active 13 Expired	add no number person up +2	—	
Exxat security3	exxat.		Silver	15 Active 48 Expired	user one	—	
Exxat Demo	exxat.		Non-Tiered Partner	2 Expired	—	—	
AutomationPrismPartner	talent.dev.exxat.net	Exxat, Inc., P.O. Box 4206, Warren, New Jersey	Tier 1 Tier 2 Gold Silver	—	testing testing 1	Physical Therapist Assistant	
AutomationNonPrismPartner	—	—	Silver	2 Expired	—	Health Promotion	

18 items

Category column now renders a chip per assigned category (overflow collapses to “+N more”).

Rows per page: 50

Figure 1. School Partners list — Category column as chips, with the Category filter open as a multi-select checklist.

5.2 Row-level “Edit Category” panel

The single-select dropdown is replaced by a multi-select checklist inside the same slide-over: a search box, a pinned “SELECTED (n)” band above a divider showing currently-checked categories, and the remaining categories below. University Name, Alias Name, and Address stay read-only, unchanged from today. Update is disabled whenever zero categories are checked — enforcing the resolved minimum-one-category rule (section 2).

Exxat One Bedlam Physical Therapy

Dashboard Ask Leo Vinay bn

Edit Category

Update

University Name: Exxat Alias Name: EO

Address: 12162 N Rancho Vistoso Blvd, Suite 120, Bengaluru, Karnataka, 560060

Partner Category

3 selected

SELECTED

Bronze Gold Tier 1

Search categories

☒ Bronze selected

☒ Gold selected

☐ Silver

☒ Tier 1 selected

☐ Tier 2

☐ Non-Tiered Partner

At least one category must remain selected — Update is disabled at zero.

Figure 2. Edit Category panel — multi-select checklist with pinned selections, replacing the single-select dropdown.

5.3 Individual school About page

The Category field in Basic Information displays as a chip stack, reflecting every category currently assigned to the school. Its edit pencil continues to open the same panel described in 5.2 — no separate About-page-specific edit surface is introduced.

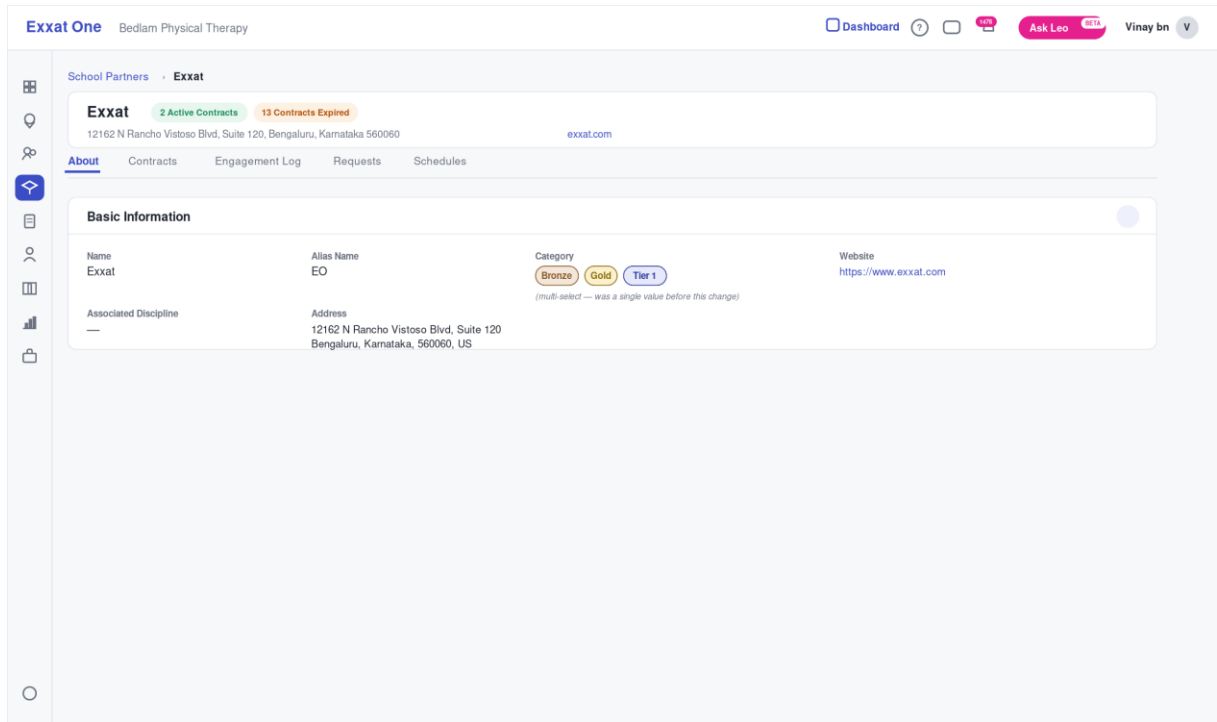


Figure 3. About page Basic Information — Category shown as a chip stack instead of a single value.

5.4 Downstream: Tiered Partners recipient picker (Publish Preference)

Because Tiered Partners' recipient-qualification query matches directly against Partner Category, a school can now qualify under more than one selected tier the moment this ships. Part 2 (Publish_Preference_School_Partners_PRD.docx, section 5.2) owns the resulting panel UI — a qualified-school count per tier and an overlap indicator so a coordinator sees this as expected, not confusing.

Resolved (Himanshu): tier membership evaluation stays LIVE — it is not snapshotted at the moment a Tiered Partners card is published or scheduled. Concretely: if a school's categories change after a Tiered Partners card was already configured, that change takes effect immediately against every card built on that tier, including cards that are already Scheduled or already Published — with no action taken on the availability itself, and no warning surfaced anywhere in this module (Part 2's own edit flow, not this one, is where any warning behavior would need to live, and this PRD does not add one here). This is a meaningful, occasionally surprising consequence of the decision, stated here plainly so engineering, QA, and support all expect it rather than treat it as a bug report later.

The Tiered Partners panel's own UI (qualified-school counts, overlap indicator) is documented in Publish_Preference_School_Partners_PRD.docx, section 5.2 and its Figure 9 — not reproduced here, to keep the two PRDs' figures scoped to what each actually owns.

5.5 Zero-category validation

Resolved (Himanshu): enforced as a hard rule at every edit surface — Update/Save is disabled whenever zero categories are selected, on both the row-level panel and the About page's edit panel. A school can never be saved into a zero-category state, which is also what keeps Tiered Partners from silently losing reachability to a school (see Part 2, Open Questions).

The screenshot shows the 'Edit Category' panel in the Exxat One interface. The top navigation bar includes 'Exxat One', 'Bedlam Physical Therapy', and user information for 'Ask Leo' and 'Vinay bn'. The main content area is a dark grey rectangle. On the right, the 'Edit Category' panel is visible. It shows the 'University Name' as 'Exxat' and the 'Partner Category' as '0 selected'. A search bar for categories is present, and a list of categories with checkboxes is shown below it. The categories are Bronze, Gold, Silver, Tier 1, Tier 2, and Non-Tiered Partner. A red error message states: 'Select at least one category before saving.' The 'Update' button is disabled.

Figure 4. Edit Category panel — zero categories selected; Update stays disabled with an inline validation message.

6. Data model

Partner Category moves from a scalar field (a single foreign key or enum column) on the school partner record to a many-to-many structure — a join table, or an array column. Existing schools, each holding exactly one category today, migrate non-destructively by wrapping their existing value into a one-item array/set: no data loss, no manual backfill, and no visible change to any school until a coordinator explicitly edits its categories.

Confirmed and unconfirmed consumers: the one confirmed downstream consumer of Partner Category is Tiered Partners' recipient-qualification query, which changes from an equality match (“school.category = tier”) to a membership match (“tier IN school.categories”) for every Tiered Partners card, existing or new, the moment this ships. No other consumer was identified during this review, but that isn't the same as confirming none exists — any other report, filter, or automation keyed on a school's category as a single value inherits this same migration risk and should be checked before this ships.

7. Entry points

- School Partners list — Category column and filter (section 5.1).
- Row-level Edit action (pencil icon) — Edit Category panel (section 5.2).
- Individual school About page — Basic Information display and its edit panel (section 5.3).

8. Edge cases

Two leftover XSS-test junk values in the live Category dropdown. Found live in QA (e.g. stray script-injection test strings) — a pre-existing data hygiene issue, unrelated to this change. Flagged for cleanup as a separate item (Open Questions), not fixed silently as part of this PRD.

A school with many categories. Chip overflow must collapse to “+N more” in the list column (5.1), where space is tight and many rows are visible at once. The pinned-selected band in the Edit Category panel (5.2) and the About page chip stack (5.3) are lower-density, single-record views — the full set should remain fully visible there rather than truncating, since seeing everything currently assigned is the point of those two surfaces.

No bulk category-assignment tool exists. Updating categories for many schools at once (18+ at the tenant reviewed in QA) means one-at-a-time edits via the row-level or About-page panel. Flagged as a possible follow-up (Open Questions), not resolved here.

Category filter semantics under multiple selected categories. Whether the list-level filter (5.1) should match a school if it has ANY selected category (OR) or must have ALL of them (AND) is not decided — needs an explicit product decision before build. See Open Questions.

A school's categories change on an already-Scheduled or already-Published Tiered Partners card. Per the resolved live-evaluation decision (section 5.4), this takes effect immediately, with no warning shown anywhere in this module — any warning behavior belongs to Part 2's own Publish Preference edit flow, not to this School Partners category-editing UI. This PRD does not add a confirmation step here, since the coordinator editing a school's categories has no visibility into which availabilities' Publish Preference cards are affected by that edit.

9. Success metrics

Not tracked for this feature at launch, consistent with the sibling Publish Preference PRD — no metric was discussed for this pass. Revisit if that changes.

10. Acceptance criteria

- ☐ School Partners list Category column renders one chip per assigned category, collapsing overflow to a “+N more” indicator rather than wrapping the row.

- ☐ School Partners list Category filter supports selecting more than one category via a multi-select checklist, replacing today's single-select control.
- ☐ Row-level Edit Category panel replaces the single-select dropdown with a multi-select checklist — search box, pinned selected band, remaining categories below.
- ☐ Update/Save is disabled whenever zero categories are selected, on both the row-level Edit Category panel and the About page's edit panel.
- ☐ About page Basic Information displays Category as a chip stack reflecting every category currently assigned to the school.
- ☐ Existing schools migrate non-destructively into the new multi-value structure — no data loss, and no visible change to any school until a coordinator explicitly edits its categories.
- ☐ Tiered Partners' recipient-qualification query evaluates a school's current (live) category set at evaluation time, not a value snapshotted at an earlier point — consistent with the resolved live-evaluation decision (section 5.4). Verifiable only once Part 2's Tiered Partners panel work is also in place.

11. Open questions (need an answer before this is build-ready)

Resolved by Himanshu: tier membership stays live, not snapshotted (section 5.4); Partner Category enforces a minimum of one category (section 5.5); this work is split into two PRDs, this one and Publish_Preference_School_Partners_PRD.docx (Part 2), rather than one combined document.

Still open:

1. Category filter (5.1) — OR or AND semantics when multiple categories are selected? Needs an explicit product decision before build; Part 2's Tiered Partners multi-tier-selection matching should likely follow the same convention for consistency, so this decision affects both PRDs.
2. Should a bulk category-assignment tool be added, given there's no way today to update categories for more than one school at a time? Flagged, not resolved.
3. Should the two leftover XSS-test junk category values found in QA be cleaned up as part of this change, or tracked as a separate data-hygiene ticket? Flagged either way, not this PRD's primary scope.
4. Who is actually permitted to edit a school's Partner Category today (any Site Admin? a specific coordinator role?), and should that access differ now that the field carries more product weight (it directly drives Tiered Partners reach, section 5.4)? Section 3a's inherit-existing-access assumption is unconfirmed — needs an explicit answer before this is build-ready, not an assumption engineering discovers is wrong post-launch.

12. Out of scope / future considerations

- The School Partners Who-Sees option, its recipient picker, and Publish When/Schedule Publishing — all of Publish_Preference_School_Partners_PRD.docx (Part 2), untouched by this PRD.
- The Tiered Partners panel's overlap-handling UI (qualified-school counts, de-duplication notice) — owned by Part 2; this PRD only supplies the data-model and resolved-behavior decisions that UI depends on.
- Discover & Engage, Consortium, and Program Partner — untouched, per Part 2's existing non-goals, which still apply.
- The Contracts tab's Associated Locations data as a possible third school-qualification dimension alongside Category — a related, separate finding from QA investigation, not addressed here.
- Bulk category-assignment tooling (see Open Question 2).